INB INDIA NETWORK BULLETIN · EDITION 028 TUESDAY 3 NOVEMBER 2026 · 09:00 IST

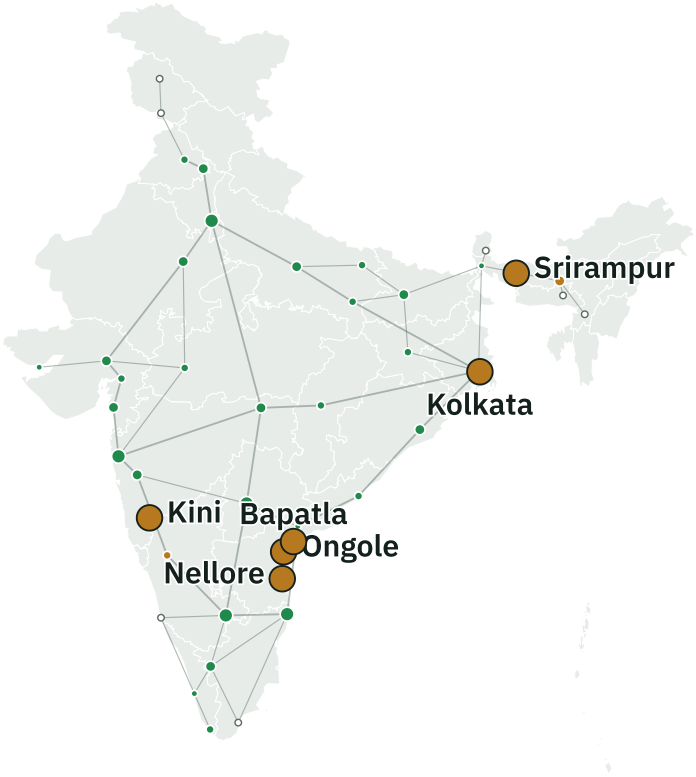
NH-16 and NH-48 each lose a delivery day this week

● NETWORK: AMBER

BEFORE DIWALI · 3 DAYS TO DHANTERAS · 5 DAYS TO DIWALI

For e-commerce, D2C and consumer-goods teams delivering orders and stocking shops through Diwali.

Three days before Dhanteras, Murasu started crossing the Andhra coast near Ongole at 1 am, right on NH-16, the Chennai–Kolkata highway[1]. And at 11 am, cane growers start an open-ended blockade of NH-48, the Pune–Bengaluru highway, in Kolhapur. So both of the south's trunk roads lose time in the same week. Kolkata, mind you, has set its Diwali curbs too: no trucks in the city from Sunday.



Map: DataMeet, CC BY 4.0

● GREEN normal for peak week: busy, but delivery promises hold
● AMBER something is slowing deliveries beyond normal peak
● RED deliveries largely stopped across a state or city, or a courier embargo on the route

DATES THAT MATTER

- **Since Sun 1 Nov** Delhi admits outside goods vehicles only if BS-VI, CNG, LNG or electric[2]
- **Tue 3 Nov** Cyclone Murasu crosses the Andhra coast near Ongole
- **From Tue 3 Nov** Cane growers' blockade of NH-48 at Kini, open-ended
- **Until Thu 12 Nov** Pune's old-city markets take goods vehicles only at night
- **Sun 8 Nov** Kolkata keeps goods vehicles off its roads for Kali Puja
- **Mon 9 – Wed 11 Nov** Kolkata curbs goods vehicles for the immersions
- **Tue 10 – Sat 14 Nov** Gujarat's markets and transport shut till Labh Pancham

DELIVERY PROMISE BY REGION

North	West	South	East	Northeast	Central
+0	+1*	+2*	+1*	+1*	+0
GREEN	AMBER	AMBER	AMBER	AMBER	GREEN

* Likely impact (#days) on delivery promise up to Diwali within the region, specific to certain cities or pincodes, beyond what is expected for the season.

Murasu crosses near Ongole, on NH-16 and the coast railway

South · Prakasam, Bapatla and Nellore on the Andhra coast; Telangana's roads next

AMBER · HIGH COST OF DELAY · MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

The landfall began at 1 am on Tuesday, with winds of 100–110 km/h gusting to 120, IMD says[1], so trucks on the coast road are held through the night and most of today. IMD expects it to weaken to a cyclonic storm by noon[3], but whether NH-16 shut overnight, nobody has said yet.

- **Ongole, Bapatla and Nellore, on NH-16** South · +2 days The eye came in where NH-16 and the Howrah–Chennai railway run side by side, with high tides and strong winds at 3:25 am, Prakasam's collector said[4]. I'd expect parcels here to arrive two days late, around Friday.

DECISIONS TO MAKE

For e-commerce and D2C teams

- Parcels already on the road to the Ongole coast can still make Diwali if NH-16 runs again by Wednesday, my estimate; new orders there likely miss Dhanteras, so promise them for Diwali.

For FMCG and consumables distribution

- When NH-16 reopens, the coast's Diwali top-ups have till Sat 7 Nov to reach shops before the festival weekend, my estimate, so they go ahead of routine loads.

What next: IMD's Hyderabad office expects extremely heavy rain at places in Nalgonda and Nagarkurnool on Wednesday, and heavy rain in Suryapet, Mahabubnagar and Wanaparthy[5]. That is NH-65 and NH-44, Hyderabad's roads to Vijayawada and Bengaluru.

Kolkata takes trucks off its roads for Kali Puja and three immersion nights

East · Kolkata, Sun 8 to Wed 11 Nov

AMBER · HIGH COST OF DELAY · HIGH CONFIDENCE

Kolkata Police bars goods vehicles from 6 am on Sunday 8 November, Kali Puja, Bengal's Diwali night, to 4 am the next day, so trucks restocking the city's hubs are held[6,7]. Vans under 1,600 kg can run till 4 pm, light goods vehicles from noon to 4 pm, and essential food supplies are exempt, of course. Then, on the 9th, 10th and 11th, goods vehicles are banned from 8 am to 4 am for the immersions, the processions taking the idols to the river.

- **Kolkata** East · +1 day Small vans keep delivering on Sunday morning, but trucks can't restock the city's delivery centres from Sunday to Wednesday. I'd expect anything not out of the hubs by Saturday 7th to be delivered late, from Thursday 12th.

DECISIONS TO MAKE

For e-commerce and D2C teams

- Kolkata's Diwali orders need to leave the city's hubs by Sat 7 Nov; anything later is safer promised from Thu 12 Nov, my estimate.

For FMCG and consumables distribution

- The last truck top-up to Kolkata's shops before Diwali is Sat 7 Nov; after that only vans under 1,600 kg, and only till 4 pm on the 8th.

Cane growers block the Pune–Bengaluru highway from 11 am

West · NH-48 at the Kini toll plaza, Kolhapur district

AMBER

A cane growers' union has called an open-ended blockade at the Kini toll plaza from 11 am today, saying it is no one-day protest[8]. It wants a first payment of ₹4,500 a tonne of cane (about $51). Kini sits on NH-48, the main road from Mumbai and Pune to Bengaluru. I'd expect trucks between them to wait or detour from this afternoon, adding a day while the blockade holds.

Truckers block NH-27 at the Assam–Bengal border

Northeast · Srirampur check gate, Kokrajhar: the main road into the Northeast

AMBER

Truck drivers blocked NH-27 near the Srirampur check gate with hundreds of vehicles after a clash with police over alleged bribes, it was reported on Monday[9]. Traffic has partly resumed. Srirampur is the road gate from the rest of India into Assam, so I'd expect Guwahati-bound trucks to run a day late this week.

SOURCES

1. Deccan Chronicle: Murasu's landfall begins near Ongole, live, 3 Nov
2. ETV Bharat: Delhi turns away BS-IV vehicles for a second day, 2 Nov
3. ETV Bharat: Murasu live, IMD's 8:07 am update, 3 Nov
4. ETV Bharat: Murasu live updates, Prakasam collector at 3:25 am, 3 Nov
5. Telangana Today: IMD heavy rain alert for Telangana districts, 3 Nov
6. Millennium Post: Kolkata Police curbs for Kali Puja and immersions, 31 Oct
7. ThePrint (PTI): Kolkata Police curbs for Kali Puja and immersions, 1 Nov
8. ChiniMandi: cane growers' NH-48 blockade at Kini from 3 Nov, 2 Nov
9. The Sentinel: Assam–Bengal border choked as truckers clash with police, 2 Nov